HAZELNUT THUMBPRINT COOKIES
WITH ROSE HIP SAUCE

makes 20 cookies

My friend and colleague Valerie Segrest shared this recipe with me. To create a rich, substantial dough completely free of any grains, she blends together hazelnut flour, hazelnut butter, and hazelnut oil. She fills the lightly sweet, chewy cookies with a sweet-tart rose hip sauce that requires no cooking. You simply blend powdered rose hips with apple cider to make a spoonable sauce and after a few minutes, it sets like magic.

In addition to the sauce, you can add a roasted hazelnut to the "thumbprint" of the cookie if you'd like.

COOKIES

- 1½ cups hazelnut flour
- ¼ cup creamy hazelnut butter, well stirred
- 1 tablespoon hazelnut oil, or more as needed
- 1 tablespoon maple syrup
- ½ teaspoon baking powder
- Pinch of sea salt
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract (optional)

SAUCE

- ⅓ cup Rose Hip Powder (recipe follows) or use store-bought
- ¼ to ½ cup unsweetened apple cider or juice
- 1 to 2 teaspoons honey (optional)
- Dried rose petals (optional), for garnish

Make the cookies: Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.

In a food processor, combine the hazelnut flour, hazelnut butter, hazelnut oil, maple syrup, baking powder, salt, and vanilla, if using, and pulse until a smooth, soft dough forms. If the dough is too dry, add a little more hazelnut oil or a splash of water.

Divide the dough into 20 equal portions and roll each one into a ball. Arrange them on the baking sheet so they are not touching. Press each one to flatten slightly, then use a thumb or kitchen tool to create a small, deep indentation at the center of each one. (From here, they will not spread.)

Bake for 12 to 15 minutes, until they're just set but still soft and chewy. (If the indentations fill in a bit, use a small melon baller to deepen them while the cookies are still warm.) Transfer to a wire rack to cool.

Make the sauce: Place the rose hip powder in a bowl. Stirring constantly, gradually pour in ¼ cup of the apple cider. The consistency should be on the thicker side of a sauce. Add more cider if needed. Taste the sauce and stir in a teaspoon or two of the honey, if desired.

Spoon a little of the rose hip sauce into the "thumbprint" of each cooled cookie. If desired, sprinkle some dried rose petals over the cookies before the sauce sets.

ROSE HIP POWDER

Makes ⅓ cup

If you're making a powder from rose hips you gather yourself, make absolutely sure you remove all of the seeds. They are hard enough to chip a tooth!

- ½ cup dried seedless rose hips

Put the dried seedless rose hips in a spice grinder (or a coffee grinder that isn't used for coffee, since you don't want the powder to taste like espresso) and grind them to a fine powder.